Simulation Arena

Competitor Pricing: The Virtual War Room

Match every cut - on these numbers it earns the most profit: $33,592.12M over 8 quarters, $11,498.14M more than Defensible niche.

Seed 42 | Run run_43a78edbe23b | 5,424 scenarios tested | Agent-based market simulation (virtual… | 22 Sep 2026, 07:43

Same seed, same numbers - this run can be reproduced exactly.

How this works

We built a virtual market out of your accounts. Each buyer has a budget, a price sensitivity and a supplier they use today. Every quarter the rivals set a price, you answer with one of three strategies, and each buyer picks a supplier - the cheapest offer usually wins, but habit, the hassle of switching and a priority-support promise all count. We then played all 2 years out 100 times for each strategy, so every number below is an average across 100 different versions of the future, with the likely range shown around it. We then ranked the three strategies on the measure you chose and re-ran the market at a range of rival undercuts to see how far the answer travels before it changes.

The numbers that matter

BEST CALL ON THESE NUMBERS

Match every cut

It scores best on profit across 100 versions of the next 8 quarters.

vs $11,498.14M more than Defensible niche

PROFIT IF YOU MATCH EVERY CUT

$33,592.12M

The best of the three on profit: $11,498.14M more than Defensible niche.

vs -19.9% price vs today, 93.9% of accounts served

PROFIT IF YOU DEFEND A NICHE

$22,093.97M

$11,498.14M less profit over 8 quarters than Match every cut.

vs -19.4% price vs today, 21.2% of accounts served

PROFIT IF YOU HOLD THE LINE

$8,514.62M

$25,077.49M less profit over 8 quarters than Match every cut.

vs -0.0% price vs today, 3.9% of accounts served

TOP-TIER ACCOUNTS YOU KEEP

93.9%

Of the top accounts you serve today, this many are still yours at the end under the best call.

vs target 88.0%

ACCOUNTS LOST TO RIVALS

95,148

Accounts that walked to a competitor across 100 versions of the two years under the best call.

vs 95,148 if you match everything

BREAK-EVEN RIVAL UNDERCUT

none in 0-40%

Not found between 0% and 40% - the recommendation does not change anywhere in that range.

HOW FAR THE RIVAL CAN MOVE BEFORE THE ANSWER CHANGES

0%-40% undercut

Match every cut stays the best call everywhere we tested, from 0% to 40% undercut. Only the rival's undercut is moved here; everything else stays as you set it.

How we got there

1. The market we built

We put 200,003 buyers in a room with you and two rivals. They are not all alike: the most profitable accounts barely react to price, while the cheapest ones chase it hard. Today you serve 100.0% of them.

Evidence: $143,359.62M of annual spend in play

2. What 'Match every cut' does

Answer every rival cut on every account, immediately. Over 8 quarters it leaves your average price -19.9% versus today, serves 93.9% of the accounts, keeps 93.9% of the top tier and banks $33,592.12M of profit - the best call on profit.

Evidence: $33,592.12M of profit over 8 quarters

3. What 'Defensible niche' does

Hold list price, bundle priority support on the accounts worth keeping, and match only where the account commits multi-year. Over 8 quarters it leaves your average price -19.4% versus today, serves 21.2% of the accounts, keeps 21.2% of the top tier and banks $22,093.97M of profit - ranked 2 of 3 on profit.

Evidence: $22,093.97M of profit over 8 quarters

4. What 'Hold the line' does

Do nothing. Keep list price everywhere and let the chips fall. Over 8 quarters it leaves your average price -0.0% versus today, serves 3.9% of the accounts, keeps 3.9% of the top tier and banks $8,514.62M of profit - ranked 3 of 3 on profit.

Evidence: $8,514.62M of profit over 8 quarters

5. The trade in plain numbers

Matching every cut wins on both counts here: it serves the most accounts (93.9%) and banks the most profit ($33,592.12M). On these numbers there is no trade-off to make.

Evidence: $33,592.12M of profit, 93.9% of accounts

6. The bottom line

Match the rival's cuts. Doing so banks $33,592.12M of profit over 8 quarters, $11,498.14M more than Defensible niche. The accounts it keeps are worth more than the discount it gives away.

Evidence: $33,592.12M for Match every cut vs $33,592.12M for matching

Charts

What happens to your price

Average across 100 versions of the future; the shaded pair is the likely range



What this shows: Each line is the average price you charge each quarter under one strategy. The band is the range of outcomes across the versions we played for the best call. A line that ends lower means more of a discount was given away.

What happens to profit

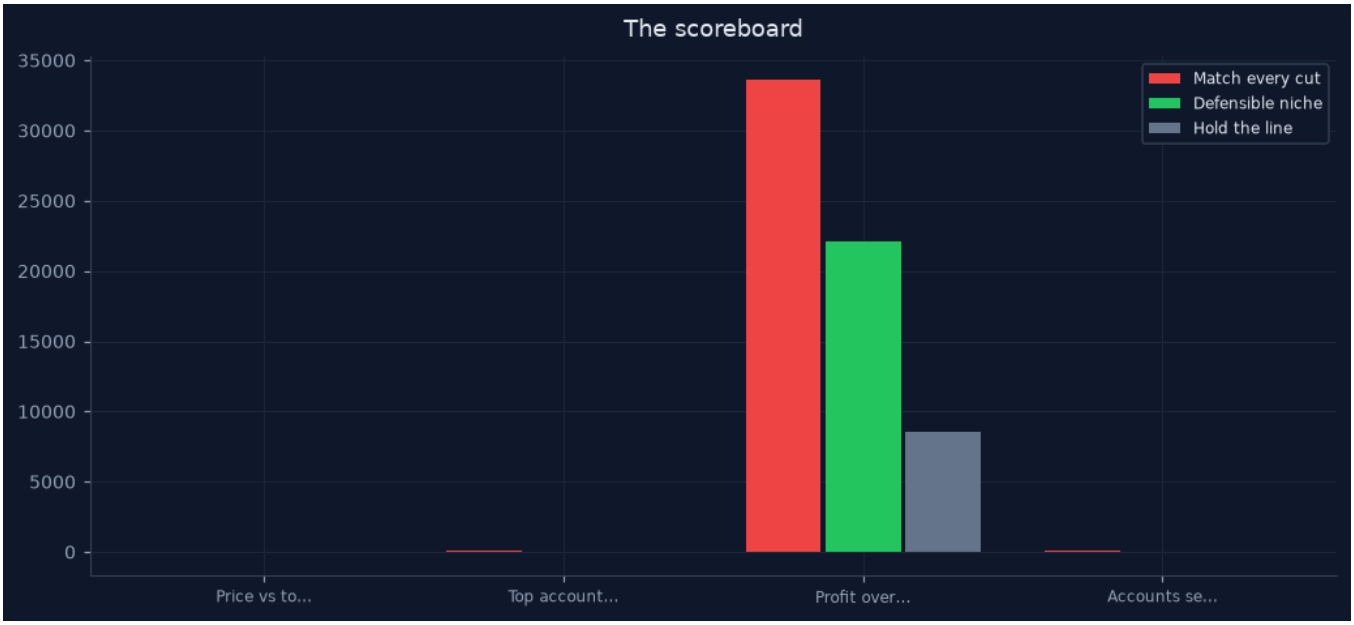
Profit per quarter, after the cost to serve and overheads



What this shows: Profit per quarter under each strategy. The line that ends highest is the one that earns the most; which line that is comes from the simulation, not from a rule of thumb.

The scoreboard

The three strategies side by side



What this shows: Four measures, three strategies, all on one axis so the bars can be compared within each group. Price is a change versus today, top accounts kept and accounts served are percentages, and profit over the whole period is in millions.

Tables

The three strategies compared

Every figure is an average of 100 simulated versions of the next 8 quarters. Ranked on profit.

Strategy	Price vs today	Revenue (2 yrs)	Profit (2 yrs)	Profit margin	Top-tier kept	Accounts served	Moves to a rival	Verdict
Match every cut	-19.9%	$225,183.17M	$33,592.12M	14.9%	93.9%	93.9%	95,148	Recommended
Defensible niche	-19.4%	$96,378.45M	$22,093.97M	22.9%	21.2%	21.2%	250,362	Not recommended - $11,498.14M less profit over 8 quarters

Strategy	Price vs today	Revenue (2 yrs)	Profit (2 yrs)	Profit margin	Top-tier kept	Accounts served	Moves to a rival	Verdict
Hold the line	-0.0%	$29,709.27M	$8,514.62M	28.7%	3.9%	3.9%	263,097	Not recommended - $25,077.49M less profit over 8 quarters

Row 1 is the best call on profit.

What happens to each tier under the best call (Match every cut)

Where you defend, where you let go, and what each tier earns you.

Tier	Accounts	Yours today	Yours after 2 yrs	Kept (of yours today)	Won from rivals	Revenue (2 yrs)	Profit (2 yrs)	Support cost per account	Call
Tier-2	200003	200,003	187,831	94%	0	$215,768.13M	$23,771.85M	$173	Let go

Profit is after the cost to serve that account.

Quarter by quarter - best call (Match every cut)

Your price, the rival's price, and what that earns.

Quarter	Your price	Rival price	Accounts served	Revenue	Profit
Q1	$94,000	$94,000	93.0%	$31,323.87M	$7,562.19M
Q2	$88,360	$88,360	93.5%	$29,625.20M	$5,717.41M
Q3	$84,180	$84,180	93.7%	$28,282.71M	$4,325.18M
Q4	$82,090	$82,090	93.8%	$27,605.88M	$3,625.93M
Q5	$81,045	$81,045	93.9%	$27,264.64M	$3,276.28M
Q6	$80,522	$80,522	93.9%	$27,094.87M	$3,101.11M
Q7	$80,261	$80,261	93.9%	$27,014.99M	$3,013.80M
Q8	$80,131	$80,131	93.9%	$26,971.02M	$2,970.23M

How far the rival's undercut can move before the answer changes

A one-factor test: only the rival's undercut moves, 6 versions of the future at each point. The row for today's undercut is highlighted.

Rival undercut	Match every cut	Defensible niche	Hold the line	Best call	Still the recommendation?
0%	$77,358.56M	$76,876.16M	$77,333.19M	Match every cut	Yes
2%	$65,431.77M	$75,370.40M	$71,321.55M	Defensible niche	No
4%	$54,070.42M	$71,864.92M	$59,802.83M	Defensible niche	No
6%	$44,365.93M	$64,421.59M	$43,191.32M	Defensible niche	No
8%	$38,855.47M	$51,513.09M	$26,798.84M	Defensible niche	No
10%	$35,600.95M	$30,594.25M	$15,215.24M	Match every cut	Yes
12%	$33,587.92M	$22,092.84M	$8,517.59M	Match every cut	Yes
14%	$32,009.36M	$17,508.43M	$4,830.62M	Match every cut	Yes
16%	$31,346.21M	$15,108.60M	$2,801.33M	Match every cut	Yes
18%	$30,675.22M	$13,013.30M	$1,642.45M	Match every cut	Yes
20%	$30,000.32M	$12,579.14M	$969.04M	Match every cut	Yes
22%	$30,005.22M	$12,569.77M	$970.40M	Match every cut	Yes
24%	$30,001.62M	$12,569.83M	$965.21M	Match every cut	Yes
26%	$30,002.86M	$12,575.36M	$969.22M	Match every cut	Yes
28%	$30,007.95M	$12,575.94M	$969.76M	Match every cut	Yes
30%	$30,003.61M	$12,575.46M	$975.30M	Match every cut	Yes
32%	$30,006.66M	$12,572.53M	$962.76M	Match every cut	Yes

Rival undercut	Match every cut	Defensible niche	Hold the line	Best call	Still the recommendation?
34%	$30,010.77M	$12,573.20M	$970.03M	Match every cut	Yes
36%	$30,002.01M	$12,574.38M	$968.89M	Match every cut	Yes
38%	$30,001.31M	$12,569.99M	$965.65M	Match every cut	Yes
40%	$30,002.01M	$12,569.65M	$966.79M	Match every cut	Yes

Not found between 0% and 40% - the recommendation does not change anywhere in that range.

What we recommend

Authorise matching the rival's cuts - on these numbers it earns more profit than holding firm.

Risk Low 25 out of 100 | Confidence: High

Why

• Match every cut scores best on profit: $33,592.12M over 8 quarters, against $33,592.12M for matching every cut.

• Matching every cut leaves your average price -19.9% versus today and serves 93.9% of the accounts; Match every cut serves 93.9% at -19.9%.

• Not found between 0% and 40% - the recommendation does not change anywhere in that range.

What to do

1. Tell sales to match the rival's cut on the accounts we want to keep.

2. Cap the match at 12.0% margin - below that, walk away.

3. Keep the priority-support promise, but charge for it where the account will pay.

4. Re-check monthly: the answer held everywhere from 0% to 40% undercut.

The trade-off: You are choosing $33,592.12M of profit with Match every cut over $33,592.12M with matching every cut - a difference of $0.

What we assumed and what to watch

Worth knowing before you act

• We could not see an obvious 'Us' in your supplier column, so we assumed 'Competitor A' is you.

• Your file holds 400,000 rows. We are running on an evenly spread sample of 200,003 of them (50.0%), keeping rows intact rather than splitting a record down the middle, because a working set that big does not fit in memory while keeping the tool responsive. Every number below comes from those 200,003 rows.

Assumptions

• 200,003 accounts from your file; each buyer keeps buying the same volume each quarter.

• List price $100,000 per unit; margin 28.7% on average, so cost is 71.3% of list.

• Rivals undercut your previous average price by 12.0% and close 50% of the gap each quarter, down to a floor of 20.0% off list.

• Buyers weigh price about ten times more heavily than habit; a 6.0% priority-support promise counts like a discount of half that size, and costs 1.5% of margin.

• 40% of top-tier accounts are willing to commit multi-year (60% of that rate in the mid tier).

• Overheads of $5.00M a year are charged against profit.

• The recommendation maximises profit; change it and the answer may change with it.

• Robustness check: the rival's undercut alone moves, from 0% to 40% in 2-point steps, with 6 versions of the future at each point. Every other assumption is held where it is today.

• 100 independent versions of 8 quarters per strategy; seed 42 (re-running gives identical numbers).

• Columns read from your file: Account / customer ID, Annual spend with you, Price sensitivity (0-1), Margin on the account (%), Annual cost to support them.

• Account / customer ID -> your 'account_id' column

• Account tier / segment -> not in your file; not used

• Annual spend with you -> your 'annual_recurring_revenue' column

• Price sensitivity (0-1) -> your 'submitted_list_price' column

• Who supplies them today -> not in your file; not used

• Margin on the account (%) -> your 'realised_gross_margin_pct' column

• Annual cost to support them -> your 'rep_annual_quota_attainment_pct' column

• Data used: 200,003 of the 400,000 rows in your file (50.0%), drawn evenly across it.

Appendix: the last steps of the run

Every line was produced while the model ran. Re-running with the same seed replays it exactly.

Time	Stage	What happened
1.07s	prepare	Annual cost to support them -> your 'rep_annual_quota_attainment_pct' column
4.92s	prepare	Read 200,003 records into the model.
4.92s	simulate	Running the simulation…
4.92s	read	Reading the account book...
5.70s	validate	We could not see an obvious 'Us' in your supplier column, so we assumed 'Competitor A' is you.
5.70s	prepare	Built the market from 200,003 accounts from your file.
5.70s	prepare	Three suppliers are in the room: you, Competitor A and Competitor B.
32.80s	simulate	Running the war room... 10% of the worlds simulated
57.07s	simulate	Running the war room... 20% of the worlds simulated
68.87s	simulate	Running the war room... 30% of the worlds simulated
72.76s	simulate	Match every cut: 100 versions played out.
81.93s	simulate	Running the war room... 40% of the worlds simulated
95.75s	simulate	Running the war room... 50% of the worlds simulated
109.32s	simulate	Running the war room... 60% of the worlds simulated
118.69s	simulate	Defensible niche: 100 versions played out.
122.13s	simulate	Running the war room... 70% of the worlds simulated
132.21s	simulate	Running the war room... 80% of the worlds simulated
142.42s	simulate	Running the war room... 90% of the worlds simulated
152.26s	simulate	Running the war room... 100% of the worlds simulated
152.59s	simulate	Running the war room... 100% of the worlds simulated
152.69s	simulate	Hold the line: 100 versions played out.
152.69s	summarize	Scoring the three strategies against each other...
152.69s	simulate	Testing how far the rival's undercut can move before the answer changes...
387.99s	summarize	Not found between 0% and 40% - the recommendation does not change anywhere in that range.
388.04s	summarize	Done. Match every cut scores best on profit: $33,592.12M over 8 quarters.